SHAGGAR INSTITUTE OF TECHNOLOGY
Excellence in Science and Technology

English 101 - Course Syllabus

## 1. Basic Course Information

- Course Code and Title: ENGL 1720 – **Writing & Rhetoric II**
- Credit Hours: 3
- Instructor(s): Karen Sichler
- Semester/Quarter: Winter 2026, Second Quarter
- Prerequisites: ENGL 1610
- Co-requisites: N/A
- Class Schedule: Tuesday/Thursday 7:30 to 9:30 EST / 15:30 to 17:30 Addis Ababa, Ethiopia
- Office Hours: By Appointment
- Contact Information: sichler.karen@gmail.com
- Breakout contacts:
  - Arianna: awin78396@gmail.com
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## 2. Course Description

This course introduces first-year university students to rhetoric, technical and scientific writing, persuasion, evidence-based argumentation, and digital rhetoric, with a central focus on producing a professional white paper for a real or hypothetical client. It trains students to analyze audiences, structure information, use ethical persuasion, evaluate sources, and propose research-informed solutions, preparing them for academic and professional communication in technical and scientific contexts.

## 3. Course Objectives

Upon successful completion of the course, students will be able to:

1. Apply rhetorical principles and the 5 Canons of Rhetoric in technical writing.
2. Conduct research using peer-reviewed and credible professional sources in APA format.
3. Develop a complete White Paper addressing a real-world organizational problem or opportunity.
4. Analyze evidence, audiences, and stakeholders in technical contexts.
5. Use digital rhetoric and AI ethically in writing tasks.

## 4. Student Learning Outcomes (ABET Outcomes 1–7)

Upon successful completion of the course, students will be able to:

1. Identify and analyze a real-world organizational problem or opportunity and support its significance with research evidence.
2. Develop research-informed solutions and propose concrete, measurable recommendations for an organization.
3. Produce clear, organized, and audience-appropriate academic and technical writing, including a reflective essay and a professional White Paper, using APA conventions.
4. Demonstrate ethical writing practices, including responsible use of AI, proper citation, and evaluation of source credibility.
5. Participate in peer-editing and in-class writing activities to improve academic communication skills.
6. Locate, evaluate, synthesize, and analyze peer-reviewed and credible professional sources to support technical arguments.
7. Demonstrate independent learning through progressive topic development, research refinement, and completion of a final White Paper.

## 6. Mapping to Program Outcomes

| ABET Outcomes | Course Objectives |
|---|---|
| 1. Identify and analyze a real-world organizational problem or opportunity and support its significance with research evidence. | 2,3, and 4 |
| 2. Develop research-informed solutions and propose concrete, measurable recommendations for an organization. | 3 |
| 3. Produce clear, organized, and audience-appropriate academic and technical writing, including a reflective essay and a professional White Paper, using APA conventions | 1 |
| 4. Demonstrate ethical writing practices, including responsible use of AI, proper citation, and evaluation of source credibility. | 1 and 5 |
| 5. Participate in peer-editing and in-class writing activities to improve academic communication skills. | 1 |
| 6. Locate, evaluate, synthesize, and analyze peer-reviewed and credible professional sources to support technical arguments. | 2 and 4 |
| 7. Demonstrate independent learning through progressive topic development, research refinement, and completion of a final White Paper. | 3 |

## 6. Required Textbooks and References

Graff, Gerald & Birkenstein, Cathy. *They say, I say: The moves that matter in academic writing*. New York. W.W. Norton & Company, Ltd., 2024.

Other resources, as listed on the schedule

## 8. Course Topics and Schedule

| Readings & Lectures | Assignments & Exams |
|---|---|
| **Module 1: Introduction to Rhetoric**<br>➢ 19 February to 22 February | |
| ▪ Lecture: What is Rhetoric?<br>▪ Reading 1: Chapter 1: A Rhetorical Perspective in Kohrs Campbell, K., Schultz Huxman, S., & Burkholder, T. R. (2015). *The rhetorical act: Thinking, speaking, and writing critically* (5th ed.). Cengage Learning.<br>▪ Chapter 13: Writing About Places in Zinsser, W. (2001). *On writing well: The classic guide to writing nonfiction*. Quill | ▪ Bring a draft of your "Reflections of Home" essay to your breakout session for peer- editing |
| **Module 2: The 5 Cannons of Rhetoric – Invention & Style**<br>➢ 23 February to March 1 | |
| ▪ Lecture 1: Invention<br>▪ Lecture 2: Style<br>▪ Reading: Chapter 2: Decisions in Planning in Lannon, J. M. (2009). *The writing process: A concise rhetoric, reader, and handbook* (10th ed.) Longman. | ▪ Submit your "Reflections of Home" essay by 11:59 pm Sunday |
| **Module 3: Rhetorical Devices**<br>2 March to 8 March | |

| | |
|---|---|
| ▪ Lecture 1: Rhetorical Devices 1<br>▪ Lecture 2: Rhetorical Devices 2<br>▪ Reading: Chapter 10: Style: Composition and Ornament in Crowley, S. & Hawhee, D. (2009). *Ancient rhetorics for contemporary students* (4th ed.) Pearson Longman Publishers. | ▪ Begin brainstorming your potential topics for your White Paper Assignment |
| **Module 4: The 5 Cannons of Rhetoric – Arrangement, Memory & Delivery**<br>➢ March 9 to March 15 | |
| ▪ Lecture 1: Arrangement<br>▪ Lecture 2: Memory & Delivery<br>▪ Readings: Chapter 1: Understanding Argument & Chapter 4: Critiquing an Argument in Crusius, T. W. & Channell, C. E. (2015). *The aims of argument: A Text and reader*. McGraw Hill Education. | ▪ Submit Assignment 1 for your final white paper 2 – 3 potential topics |
| **Module 5: Information Architecture & Organization**<br>➢ 16 March to 22 March | |
| ▪ Lecture 1: The importance of Organization in writing<br>▪ Lecture 2: What is Information Architecture?<br>▪ Reading: Chapter 3: Constructing the Paper: Planning, Researching, Writing in Nosich, G. (2021). *Critical writing: A guide to writing a paper using the concepts and process of critical thinking*. Rowman & Littlefield. | |
| **Mid-Term Exam** | |

| **Module 6: The Artistic Proofs & Persuasion**<br>➢ 23 March to 29 March | |
|---|---|
| ▪ Lecture 1: The role of Persuasion in Technical Writing<br>▪ Lecture 2: Ethos, Pathos, & Logos<br>▪ Reading: Chapter 6: Rhetorical Appeals: Logos, Pathos, and Ethos Defined in Peters, J., Bates, J., Martin-Elston, E., Johann, S. Maples, R., Regan, A., White, M. (n.d.). *Writing arguments in STEM*. https://pressbooks.calstate.edu/writingargumentsinstem/ | ▪ Submit Assignment 2 (Topic selection) for your white paper |
| **Module 7: The Role of Evidence in Rhetoric**<br>➢ 30 March to 5 April | |
| ▪ Lecture: Evidence in Writing<br>▪ Readings: Chapter 6: Claims & Chapter 7: Support in Rottenberg, A. T. & Haisty Winchell, D. (2021). *The structure of argument* (10th ed.). Bedford/St. Martin's. | |
| **Module 8: Logical Fallacies**<br>➢ 6 April to 12 April | |
| ▪ Lecture 1: Argument & Logical Fallacies<br>▪ Lecture 2: Types of Logical Fallacies<br>▪ Reading: Chapter 12: Logic in Rottenberg, A.T. & Winchell, D. H. (2021). *The structure of argument* (10th ed.). Bedford/St Martin's. | ▪ Submit Assignment 3 (Background & Overview of the Problem / Stakeholders) for your white paper |

| **Module 9: The Role of Audience in Technical & Scientific Writing**<br>➢ 13 April to 19 April | |
|---|---|
| ▪ Lecture 1: Why Audience is Important<br>▪ Lecture 2: Types of Audiences<br>▪ Reading 1: Chapter 1: Introduction in Finklestein, L., Aune, J. E., & Potter, L. A. (2023). *Technical writing for engineers & scientists* (4th ed.). McGraw Hill.<br>▪ Reading 2: Chapter 3: Defining your communication's goals in Anderson, P. V. (2018). *Technical communication: A reader-centered approach* (9th ed). Cengage Learning. | ▪ Submit Assignment 4 (Proposed Solutions & Final Recommendations) for your white paper |
| **Module 10: AI & Writing**<br>➢ 20 April to 24 April | |
| ▪ Lecture 1: Ethics<br>▪ Lecture 2: How to use AI in writing<br>▪ Readings: Chapter 14: Composing scientific English & Chapter 15: Improving scientific English in Harmon, J. E. & Gross, A. G. (2010). *The craft of scientific communication*. The University of Chicago Press. | |
| Final Paper Due: 26 April @ 11:59 pm (Sunday) White Paper | |
| | |
| **Final Exam** | |

## 8. Laboratory Component

In your breakout sessions with your tutors, you will work on your assignments and review concepts discussed in lecture.

## 9. Grading Policy

| Assignments & Exams | Points |
|---|---|
| ▪ Reflections of Home – Nature Essay | 75 points |
| ▪ Assignment 1 (White Paper) | 50 points |
| ▪ Assignment 2 (White Paper) | 50 points |
| ▪ Assignment 3 (White Paper) | 100 points |
| ▪ Assignment 4 (White Paper) | 125 points |
| ▪ White Paper (Final Paper) | 200 points |
| ▪ Mid-Term Exam | 150 Points |
| ▪ Final Exam | 150 Points |
| ▪ Participation | 100 points |

Grading Scale

| | | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1000 to 940 points | A+ | 839 to 800 points | B | 699 to 670 points | C- |
| 939 to 900 points | A | 799 to 770 points | B- | 669 to 600 points | D |
| 899 to 870 points | A- | 769 to 740 points | C+ | 599 to 0 points | F |
| 869 to 840 points | B+ | 739 to 700 points | C | | |

**Reflections of home / Nature Essay:**

Students will write 600 to 1200 words on a historical or natural wonder from the area they are from. Those who write the best essays may be asked to take part in a publication highlighting the history and natural beauty of Ethiopia

**Assignment #1**

Submit 2–3 potential ideas for your final white paper. You may select to write:

- Paper for a hypothetical client concerning a real-world issue or opportunity
- Paper for a real-world client (i.e Ethiopian Airlines) concerning a real-world issue or opportunity

**For this assignment, you must turn in:**

- Client and Problem (1 short paragraph)
    - Name and briefly describe the organization (client).
    - State the potential problem or opportunity (1–2 sentences) that could be the focus of your white paper

- 2 Preliminary Sources
    - Types:
        - 1 peer-reviewed
        - 1 popular or professional press (trade press, news, industry or governmental report, credible website)
- Requirements:
    - Presented in APA style
    - Annotated
        - Summarize the main argument and findings
        - Explain how the source helps you understand the problem/opportunity or possible solutions
        - Note any limitations

Format:
- APA title page
- Organized by Idea 1, Idea 2
- Annotations need to be in paragraph style

<u>Assignment #2 - Final Topic and Client Selection with Annotated Sources</u>
You will select your final white paper topic and confirm the client organization. In addition, you will add to your research and further define your problem/solution.
For this submission, you must include:
- Expanded Client Background
    - Describe the organization (if hypothetical, create your dream client)
    - Mission
    - Section/Industry
    - Size
    - Core Services/Products
    - Context
    - Identify key stakeholders [who are affected]
- Rationale for Client and Topic Selection
    - What is your interest in this client/organization (if it is hypothetical, what about the industry)
    - Why is this problem or opportunity significant?
    - Demonstrate its timeliness

            - Explain how you believe this research and eventual recommendations could be useful to decision makers in this organization
- 2 Additional Sources
    - Types:
        - 1 Peer-reviewed
        - 1 additional credible source (popular, trade, government, or industry)
    - Requirements:
        - APA reference
        - Annotation including:
            - Summary of key findings
            - How the source will help you with the different sections of your white paper (background, problem description, perspectives/alternatives, recommendations)
            - Credibility evaluation

<u>Assignment #3 - Background & Overview of the Problem and Stakeholders Sections</u>

For this assignment, you will write the background and overview of the specific problem and stakeholders sections for your white paper. Your writing style should be addressed to a non-expert so that a large audience can understand the context, significance, and key issues related to the problem/opportunity. In this section, you will be synthesizing your research on the problem/opportunity as it currently exists

For this submission, you should include:

- Background:
    - A short overview of the industry as a whole and its relevance to the economy of Ethiopia
    - An explanation of the larger issue or trend that frames your client's specific problem/opportunity
    - Summary and synthesis of 4 - 5 credible sources, allowing you to:
        - Define the issue and key concepts
        - Provide an overview of the relevant history
        - Give an understanding of the causes of the current problem/opportunity
        - Demonstrate why this issue is relevant to organizations such as the one you selected and other stakeholders
- Overview of the Problem & Stakeholders:
    - Clearly define your client's specific problem

- Provide evidence that the problem exists in this organization or that the opportunity is available to the organization
- Identify and briefly analyze key stakeholders:
    - Who is affected?
    - How are they affected?
- Connect the it to the overview from Assignment 3

Format:

- 3 - 4 double-spaced pages
- 12 pt font
- 1" margins on all sides
- APA title page
- APA reference list
- APA in-text citations

Assignment #4 - White Paper - Proposed Solutions & Final Recommendations Sections

- Identify 2–3 feasible, research-informed solutions or approaches that organizations use to address this kind of problem.
- For each solution, create a subsection that includes:
    - A concise description of the solution.
    - Evidence of its effectiveness or limitations from at least one credible source.
    - An analysis of advantages, disadvantages, and likely stakeholder responses.
- Select one primary solution (or a combination of solutions) that you will recommend to the client.
- Present 2–4 concrete recommendations, each in its own subsection, that specify:
    - What action should be taken.
    - Who should be responsible for implementing it.
    - A realistic timeline and required resources.
    - The expected impact and how success could be measured.

Format:

- 3 - 4 double-spaced pages
- 12 pt font
- 1" margins on all sides
- APA title page
- APA reference list
- APA in-text citations

Participation

You will turn in the daily in-class writing you do at the beginning of class.

Each day is worth 5 points – We are grading on completion

Mid-Term & Final Exams

- The material will come from the lectures and the assigned readings

- Questions can be in the following formats:
    - True/False
    - Fill-in-the-blank
    - Matching
    - Multiple Choice

***For SIT's policies about Academic Integrity, Class Attendance, Classroom Behavior, Accessibility and Student Support, and Safety Considerations, please read the SIT Student Manual.***

In particular the following three policies are essential for this course.

- ***Academic Honesty:*** *Cheating on a test or assignment seriously undermines the integrity of the academic system and will not be tolerated. Although a student is not cheating, he or she is expected to refrain from actions that could be suspicious. Using common sense on your part should avoid unnecessary embarrassment.*
- ***Attendance:*** *Attendance will be taken at every meeting. Students are expected to attend every online class and to be on time. If you are absent from any online and/or in person class for any reason, it is your responsibility to find out what you missed, including any announcements.*
- ***Classroom Behavior:*** *You are expected to be in the classroom before the start of class time and leave at the end of the class time. Excessive talks without the permission of the instructors is prohibited. The use of any electronic device is allowed for the lecture and class activities only.*